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SKAO Regional Centre United Kingdom

AI attribution humans to agents

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Levels of AI adoption

Prompt Engineering

Crafting a single best instruction for an AI model

Context Engineering

Managing what information the model sees

Harness Engineering

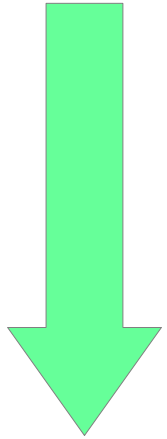
Building the local environment where an agent runs

Loop Engineering

Designing workflows that drive the agent toward completion

https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/loop-engineering

Where we started in December 2025



Where we are in October 2026

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June 2026 - Harness engineerig

Harness Engineering, automated attribution.
https://github.com/Zarquan/Acsala-agents

AI metrics block added automatically

```
AIMetrics: [
    {
    "timestamp": "2026-08-26T13:00:15",
    "name": "Cursor CLI",
    "version": "2026.02.13-41ac335",
    "model": "Claude 4.6 Opus (Thinking)",
    ....
    }
]
```



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October 2026 - Agent identity

Agent identity based on user's own identity.

```
AGENT_GIT_NAME="DeepSeek Harness"
AGENT_GIT_EMAIL="zrq-github+dsh@metagrid.co.uk"
```



- ** this is not a valid email address **
- Next step is to create a separate account for "Dave's agent"

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June 2026 - Claude identity

Claude Code automatically appends AI attribution metadata to the bottom of the commit message body by default.

```
Co-Authored-By: Claude Sonnet 4.6 <noreply@anthropic.com>
```

Active debate on X about crediting Claude as an author

“I strongly disagree with crediting Claude as a commit co-author. It is a tool I'm paying for, not a copyright holder, not an author. We don't credit Visual Studio.”
- Constantine K

“Not crediting Claude on your stuff when it's the one writing all the code is incredibly dishonest. You want to deceive people into thinking you're the one that wrote it?”

https://explainx.ai/blog/claude-code-commit-co-author-attribution-disable-guide-2026

generated by @deepseek-ai/dsh (deepseek-flash)
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October 2026 - Where we are now

Harness Engineering

- User asks the agent to make a plan.
- Agent writes the plan ....
- **User reviews and agrees the plan.**
- Agent writes the code ....

- Agent creates commit message with attribution.
- Agent waits for the human to approve the commit.
- **User reviews and approves the commit.**

- Agent commits the changes and creates pull request.
- **User reviews and approves the pull request.**

- Agent merges the pull request, updates clones and forks.

**** the human is still in the loop ****

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November 2026 - What's next

Loop Engineering

Designing workflows that drive the agent toward completion

https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/loop-engineering

"Loop engineering is the practice of designing agentic workflows, or loops, that iteratively guide AI agents toward completing user-defined goals with minimal human intervention."

"Rather than require human prompting at every step, agent loops enable agents to dynamically act, observe, make decisions and iterate until a task is complete."

If we remove the human oversight, what happens to copyright ?

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2027 going forward - What happens to copyright ?

United States (USCO Rules)

No Human Authorship = No Copyright:

“The U.S. Copyright Office requires a human author for a work to qualify for copyright protection. Software generated entirely or predominantly by AI without substantial human creativity is placed into the public domain.”
https://pec.ac.uk/blog_entries/copyright-protection-in-ai-generated-works/

United Kingdom (CDPA 1988 Rules)

“Computer-Generated Works (Section 9(3)): The UK Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988 explicitly recognizes computer-generated works (CGWs) that have no traditional human author.”

“Authorship and ownership go to "the person by whom the arrangements necessary for the creation of the work are undertaken" (often the person or company that ran/directed the AI system).”

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2027 going forward - What happens to copy left ?

The more you lean on AI to write code for you, the less likely you are to hold copyright on the result.

In the extreme case of "vibe coding," where you only describe the end product and the AI does all the work, you may not be able to claim any copyright at all.

https://allthingsopen.org/articles/copyright-problem-ai-generated-code-open-source-licenses

... but open source licensing relies on copyright

- Important to me because I am an advocate for copyleft licenses.
- Everything I've produced in the last 20+ years has been published under the terms of the GPL.
- That might no longer be possible ..

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Summary - AI attribution

I think it is important that we declare how much of what we produce is AI generated.

- Provenance - where did this come from ?
- Copyright and licensing
- Funding requirements
  - EU requires the use of open weight models to qualify for funding ?
- Security issues
  - Security vulnerability found in code generated by a model.
  - Malware injected by a specific harness.
- As a courtesy to our colleagues :
  - These slides were edited by hand
  - This email was generated by an AI
- Using agent rules makes it automatic.
  https://github.com/Zarquan/Acsala-agents

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Thank you

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GitHub

https://github.com/Zarquan/Lithosia-docker

https://github.com/Zarquan/Acsala-agents

Running to keep up

Please join the discussion.

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